

Multi-Functional Devices

Multi-Function Devices (MFDs) come in where scanning, printing, fax and copy functions all need to be done. Ever since they got cheaper, even home users have begun considering MFDs as a viable replacement for separate scanners, copiers and printers. They're a great solution for all kinds of office, partly because they save so much space. The quality of copies you get from MFDs is higher than from standalone copiers. A laser MFD gives excellent fax prints. Laser MFDs are a better choice than inkjet MFDs—they afford low cpp, whether printed or copied, and print quality is also good.

Samsung SCX 4016

Fast to print, slow to scan

The SCX 4016 offers laser printing, digital copying and colour scanning, but doesn't integrate faxing. The operation console is intuitive, with button functions clearly marked. The little LCD panel displays sufficient information, but it could have been larger. It is built for economy, with such features as Toner Save. Paper handling is via a 250-sheet capacity paper cassette. There's also a single-sheet feeding mechanism on the front side.

The printer unit is the ML-1710, the fastest laser printer we've tested so far. The scanner unit performance was not up to the mark—the IT8 card's tonal deviation test did not show great results. Results were similarly poor in the dark region of the IT8 card, but with acceptable resolution. Copies on the 4016 were crisp and clear, and the time it took for a copy was average (10 seconds).

At Rs 36,000, the SCX 4016 is a good deal if you want a

One reason for the popularity of MFDs is that they can increase productivity in offices. As one example, instead of scanning a document, OCRing it, and then taking it to the copier, which may be at a different location, these can all be done from one computer attached to the MFD.

Laser MFDs are the ideal choice for small firms like legal advisory firms and accounting firms; legal documents, account statements, bills, etc., are usually printed on standard stationery. In these situations, mono printing is preferred over colour, leaving the inkjet as both a low-quality and a more expensive option.

laser MFD with fast printing and decent print-outs. The unit as a whole should be up to the task in a typical office.



- + Single sheet feed mechanism present
- No fax function
- Average quality scanning unit
- Price: Rs 36,000

Samsung SCX 4016		B+
Performance	▬ ▬ ▬ ▬ ▬	
Features	▬ ▬ ▬ ▬ ▬	
Value for money	▬ ▬ ▬ ▬ ▬	

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